HCCS

Human Capital Control Standard

Implementation Guide

HCCS-IG-1.0

Aligned to HCCS-1.0 Core Standard | Version 1.0 | March 2026

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1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Purpose

This guide provides implementation, evidence, and audit testing guidance for all 67 controls defined in HCCS-1.0. It translates normative requirements into operational design, maps controls to evidence, and defines audit test procedures in Inspect-Verify-Conclude format. This guide is designed to enable independent verification of control operation and decision integrity.

1.2 Relationship to Core Standard

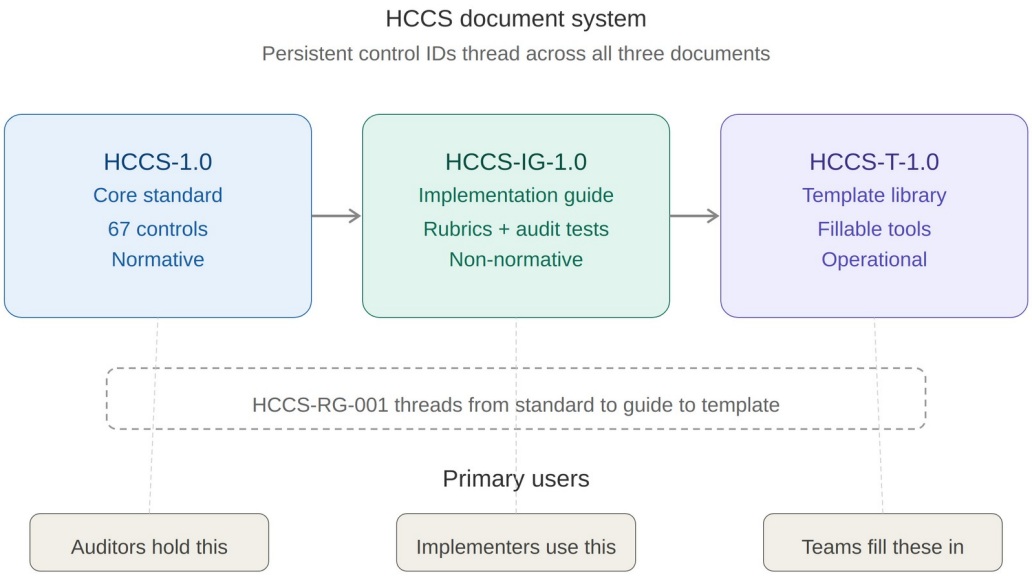
HCCS-1.0 defines what is required. This guide defines how to implement, demonstrate, and verify. The Core Standard is normative. This guide is non-normative but audit-aligned: departure from implementation guidance does not constitute non-compliance, provided the underlying control is satisfied and evidence is sufficient.

1.3 How to Use This Guide

Each domain section provides: maturity level progression criteria, implementation requirements, operational design guidance, scoring rubrics, audit test procedures (Inspect-Verify-Conclude), worked examples across role types (executive, technical, operational, hourly), and control failure examples with severity classification.

1.4 Governing Principle

If you cannot produce the evidence, the control does not exist.



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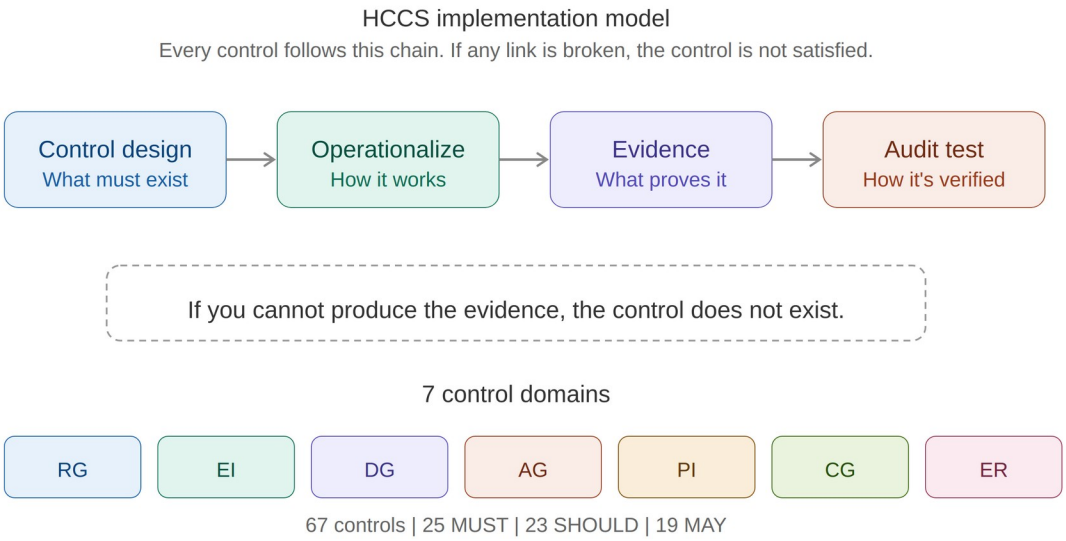
2. Implementation Model

2.1 Control-Evidence-Audit Chain

Every control follows a four-link chain. If any link is broken, the control is not satisfied.

1. Control Design	2. Operationalization	3. Evidence	4. Audit Test
What must exist per the Core Standard	How it is implemented in practice	What proves the control was applied	How an auditor verifies compliance



2.2 Minimum Compliance: Level 3

Level 3 (Defined) requires: all 25 MUST controls operational, all 23 SHOULD controls implemented or justified, complete contemporaneous evidence, and validated self-assessment by a qualified assessor.

2.3 Actuarial vs. Clinical Judgment

The Core Standard (Section 4.1) establishes that structured actuarial methods outperform clinical judgment. Implementation consequences:

- **Structured over unstructured:** Every evaluation uses pre-defined criteria, consistent application, and documented scoring. Unstructured interviews do not satisfy HCCS requirements.
- **Criteria before candidates:** Criteria, scales, and authority established before any candidate is assessed. Criteria adjusted after seeing candidates indicates clinical judgment.

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- **Evidence before synthesis:** Evaluators document scores before group deliberation. Conclusions before documentation indicates post-decision rationalization.
- **Calibration over confidence:** Evaluator confidence does not correlate with accuracy. Confidence is not accepted as evidence. Inter-rater reliability (.70+) is the measurable standard.

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3. Scoring Rubric Framework

All evaluation uses a 5-point anchored behavioral scale. Scores MUST reference observable evidence, not impressions.

Score	Label	Behavioral Anchor
1	**Does Not Meet**	No evidence of capability. Response absent, irrelevant, or fundamentally misaligned.
2	**Partially Meets**	Awareness demonstrated but limited evidence. Vague, theoretical, or lacking specificity.
3	**Meets**	Adequate evidence with specific actions, decisions, or outcomes. Sufficient to conclude capability.
4	**Exceeds**	Strong evidence across multiple contexts. Depth, adaptability, and clear impact demonstrated.
5	**Exceptional**	Mastery with compelling evidence at or above role scope. Pattern recognition and systems thinking evident.

3.1 Scoring Rules

- **No half-scores.** Integer values 1-5 only. If uncertain, select the lower score and document the ambiguity.
- **No averaging.** Each criterion scored independently. Overall assessment is structured synthesis, not mathematical.
- **Evidence required for 4 or 5.** Unsupported high scores are a scoring integrity failure.
- **Rationale required for 1 or 2.** Unsupported low scores are equally a scoring integrity failure.

3.2 Cognitive Bias Mitigation in Scoring

- **Anchoring:** Score each criterion independently. First score must not influence subsequent scores.
- **Confirmation bias:** Document both supporting and contradicting evidence.
- **Halo/horn effect:** Strong/weak response on one criterion does not predict unrelated criteria.
- **Contrast effect:** Score against rubric anchors, not the previous candidate.
- **Recency effect:** Review notes for full evaluation, not just most recent response.

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4.1 RG: Role Governance

Controls: HCCS-RG-001 through HCCS-RG-009

4.1.1 Maturity Progression

Level	RG: Progression
L1	Ad hoc, task-based descriptions. Created during or after sourcing.
L2	Standard template adopted. Most roles include outcomes. Some still task-based.
L3	All roles outcome-based, approved before sourcing. Peer validation standard. Role taxonomy links to compensation.
L4	Role definition quality scored. Definitions reviewed against actual execution.
L5	Periodic audits compare definitions to execution. Taxonomy benchmarked externally.

4.1.2 Implementation Requirements

Replace task-based job descriptions with outcome-based role definitions before sourcing. Each definition MUST include: business outcomes (30/60/90/annual), decision rights, accountability boundaries, required vs. learnable capabilities, and compensable factor alignment.

- **The critical shift:** Task-based says 'manage engineers.' Outcome-based says 'deliver payments platform release within 6 months, making scope/timeline tradeoffs with $500K resource authority.'

4.1.3 Operational Design

Role Definition Template: Required Fields

- Role title, department, reporting line
- Business outcomes: 30-day, 60-day, 90-day, annual
- Decision rights: unilateral, consultative, approval-required
- Accountability boundaries: owns vs. contributes
- Scope indicators: reports, budget, cross-functional exposure, ambiguity
- Required capabilities (must demonstrate at hire)
- Learnable capabilities (develop post-hire)
- Compensable factors linked to CG domain
- Approval: hiring manager + validator signature and date

4.1.4 Evidence Requirements

- Completed role definition for each position (RG-001, RG-002)

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- Pre-sourcing timestamp (RG-001)
- Approval with validator sign-off (RG-006)
- Required/learnable distinction (RG-003)
- Decision rights specified (RG-004)
- Compensation linkage (RG-007)
- Quality scores (L4+, RG-008)
- Audit reports (L5, RG-009)

4.1.5 Audit Test Procedures

Control ID	**RG-001**
Procedure	Select sample of roles. Verify role definition finalized before first candidate reviewed.
Evidence	Role definition timestamp vs. first candidate review date.
Conclusion	Definition predates review = satisfied. Created after = Critical failure.

Control ID	**RG-002**
Procedure	Inspect content for outcome-based language vs. task lists.
Evidence	Role definition content. Look for measurable outcomes, decision scope, accountability.
Conclusion	Outcomes clearly stated = satisfied. Primarily task lists = Critical failure.

Control ID	**RG-003**
Procedure	Verify capabilities explicitly categorized as required or learnable.
Evidence	Capability section with explicit classification.
Conclusion	Explicit distinction = satisfied. No classification = Significant failure.

4.1.6 Worked Examples

Executive

VP Engineering: 'Reduce production incidents 40% in 12 months while maintaining release velocity. Owns architecture decisions, $2M budget authority. Build-vs-buy independent for tooling under $200K. Required: led 50+ person team through platform migration. Learnable: company compliance framework.'

Technical

Senior Backend Engineer: 'Deliver API gateway refactor in Q2, 10x throughput, 99.9% uptime. Implementation decisions independent within architecture. Escalates to Staff+ for architecture

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changes. Required: distributed systems at >1M req/day. Learnable: internal deployment pipeline.'

Operational

DC Supervisor: 'Maintain 15K units/day at <0.5% error. Shift staffing decisions independent. Equipment purchases >$5K escalated. Required: managed 20+ hourly workers through peak. Learnable: company WMS and safety specifics.'

Hourly

Warehouse Associate: 'Pick, pack, ship 200+ orders/shift at 99.5% accuracy. Follow procedures, escalate exceptions. Required: stand 8 hrs, lift 50 lbs, follow multi-step procedures. Learnable: WMS interface, product handling.'

4.1.7 Control Failures

- **Critical:** Role created after candidates sourced.
- **Critical:** Generic task-based description used without conversion.
- **Significant:** No decision authority specified in definition.
- **Significant:** All capabilities listed as required with no learnable pathway.

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4.2 EI: Evaluation Integrity

Controls: HCCS-EI-001 through HCCS-EI-013

4.2.1 Maturity Progression

Level	EI: Progression
L1	Inconsistent criteria. Resume primary signal. No scoring documentation.
L2	Criteria from role definitions. Scoring scale in use. Capability-based replacing proxies.
L3	All evaluations structured, consistent, capability-based. Calibration .70+. Construct validity documented. Cognitive load managed.
L4	Structured debriefs. Psychometric supplements. Stereotype threat and impression management controlled.
L5	Post-hire signal detection studies. Classification accuracy tracked as metric.

4.2.2 Implementation Requirements

Every evaluation is a classification problem: correctly advance qualified candidates, correctly screen unqualified, minimize false advancement and missed talent. Methods must produce signal with construct validity.

- **Critical shift:** Clinical asks 'what is my impression?' Actuarial asks 'what does structured evidence indicate about the candidate's ability to deliver role outcomes?'

4.2.3 Operational Design

Evaluation Criteria Design

- Extract 4-6 capabilities from role definition
- Write 2-3 behavioral questions per capability
- Define 1, 3, and 5 anchors using the rubric
- Lock criteria before any candidate evaluated

Cognitive Load Management (EI-011)

- Max 4 evaluations per evaluator per day
- 15-minute minimum break between evaluations
- No evaluations in last 90 minutes of workday
- Exceptions documented and flagged for calibration review

Construct Validity (EI-010)

- Document what each method claims to measure

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- Document evidence the method actually measures that capability
- Document internal or external validation
- Document known limitations and validity threats

4.2.4 Evidence Requirements

- Evaluation criteria linked to role definitions (EI-001)
- Completed scorecards with rationale per criterion (EI-002, EI-004)
- Capability-based evidence, not proxy-based (EI-003)
- Calibration records with .70+ target (EI-006)
- Construct validity documentation per method (EI-010)
- Cognitive load scheduling records (EI-011)
- Structured debrief records (L4+, EI-007)
- Signal detection analysis (L5, EI-009)

4.2.5 Audit Test Procedures

Control ID	**EI-001/002**
Procedure	Verify criteria documented before assessment and identical across all candidates for a role.
Evidence	Criteria document timestamp. Scorecards for all candidates with identical criteria.
Conclusion	Criteria predate evaluation and consistent = satisfied. Differ or mid-process = Critical.

Control ID	**EI-006**
Procedure	Inspect calibration records. Verify inter-rater reliability targets .70+.
Evidence	Calibration session records. Reliability calculations. Remediation for below-threshold evaluators.
Conclusion	Data exists and meets/approaches .70 = satisfied. No calibration or <.50 = Significant.

Control ID	**EI-010**
Procedure	Request construct validity documentation for each evaluation method.
Evidence	Validity documentation. May include internal studies, external research, job-analysis-to-method mapping.
Conclusion	Validity documented and credible = satisfied. Method in use with no evidence = Significant.

Control ID	**EI-011**

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Procedure	Sample evaluator schedules. Verify cognitive load controls: max 4/day, breaks, no late-day without documentation.
Evidence	Evaluator calendars. Exception documentation.
Conclusion	Controls documented and generally followed = satisfied. Routinely violated = Significant.

4.2.6 Worked Examples

Executive

Criteria: strategic decision-making under ambiguity, board-level stakeholder influence, org transformation, P&L acumen. Method: structured behavioral (60 min) + case assessment with incomplete data. Scored 1-5 per criterion with written evidence.

Technical

Criteria: system design at scale, code quality, technical communication, debugging under pressure. Method: structured technical interview (45 min) + take-home design with rubric. Scored 1-5 with code review evidence.

Operational

Criteria: team leadership under pressure, safety ownership, real-time problem-solving, process improvement. Method: structured behavioral (45 min) + situational judgment test. Scored 1-5.

Hourly

Criteria: procedural accuracy, physical capability, reliability, safety awareness. Method: structured interview (30 min) + timed work sample. Scored 1-5 with performance data.

4.2.7 Control Failures

- **Critical:** Different criteria for different candidates for same role.
- **Critical:** Resume as primary signal with no structured assessment.
- **Significant:** Inter-rater reliability below .50 with no calibration program.
- **Significant:** Evaluation method lacks construct validity evidence.

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4.3 DG: Decision Governance

Controls: HCCS-DG-001 through HCCS-DG-010

4.3.1 Maturity Progression

Level	DG: Progression
L1	Decisions made but not documented. Informal rationale. No defined authority.
L2	Authority matrix exists. Decisions documented. Some 'gut feel' references remain.
L3	All decisions contemporaneous, criteria-referenced. Authority defined. Bias detection, structured debrief, rationalization detection operational.
L4	Decision review boards for high-impact hires. Metrics tracked.
L5	Published decision quality metrics. Continuous improvement from outcome data.

4.3.2 Implementation Requirements

Every decision must be reconstructable: who made it, what criteria, what evidence, when documented. Two forensic psychology principles govern: (1) post-decision rationalization is the default, not the exception; (2) group decisions are subject to conformity pressure and anchoring.

4.3.3 Operational Design

Decision Rationale Form

- Decision: hire/advance/reject
- Decision-maker: name, title, authority basis
- Date and time
- Criteria referenced with candidate scores
- Specific evidence cited
- Comparison basis: criteria-based, not overall impression
- For rejections: specific unmet criteria with evidence

Structured Debrief Protocol (DG-007)

- **Step 1:** Individual scorecards submitted before meeting.
- **Step 2:** Evidence presented per criterion. No overall assessments shared.
- **Step 3:** Score divergences discussed against specific evidence.
- **Step 4:** Individual re-scoring with documented rationale for changes.
- **Step 5:** Decision-maker makes final decision referencing criteria and evidence.

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Rationalization Detection (DG-009)

Monitor for: rationale >24 hours after decision, rationale without criteria reference, rationale contradicting scores, subjective language without criteria linkage ('not the right fit').

4.3.4 Evidence Requirements

- Decision rationale forms (DG-001)
- Contemporaneous criteria-referenced rationale (DG-002)
- Authority matrix with named decision-makers (DG-003)
- Conflict of interest disclosures (DG-004)
- Bias detection reports with named bias types (DG-005)
- Rejection rationale for final-stage candidates (DG-006)
- Debrief records showing evidence-before-assessment (DG-007)
- Rationalization detection records (DG-009)

4.3.5 Audit Test Procedures

Control ID	**DG-001/002**
Procedure	Inspect decision rationale. Verify contemporaneous, criteria-referenced, evidence-specific.
Evidence	Rationale form with timestamp. Cross-reference to scorecards.
Conclusion	Contemporaneous and criteria-referenced = satisfied. Post-hoc or 'fit' language = Critical.

Control ID	**DG-007**
Procedure	Inspect debrief records. Verify individual scorecards submitted before group discussion.
Evidence	Individual scorecard timestamps. Debrief meeting records.
Conclusion	Sequence documented = satisfied. Scores not recorded before discussion = Significant.

Control ID	**DG-009**
Procedure	Inspect rationalization detection mechanism. Review flagged decisions.
Evidence	Mechanism documentation. Flagged decisions with resolution.
Conclusion	Mechanism exists with documented resolutions = satisfied. No mechanism = Significant.

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4.3.6 Worked Examples

Executive

'Selected Candidate A for VP Engineering: strategic decision-making 5/5 (led $40M migration), org transformation 4/5 (scaled 20 to 80). Candidate B scored higher on technical depth (5 vs 4) but lower on transformation (3 vs 4), the primary 12-month outcome. Authority: CTO per matrix.'

Hourly

'Selected Candidate C for Associate: accuracy 4/5 (99.8% work sample), reliability 3/5 (consistent history), safety 4/5 (unprompted PPE identification). Candidate D higher on speed (4 vs 3) but lower on accuracy (2 vs 4), the primary criterion. Authority: Shift Supervisor per matrix.'

4.3.7 Control Failures

- **Critical:** 'Best fit' justification without criteria reference.
- **Critical:** Rationale created after hire started (post-decision rationalization).
- **Significant:** Debrief held but impressions shared before individual evidence.
- **Significant:** Rejection rationale states 'not strong enough' without identifying unmet criteria.

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4.4 AG: AI Governance

Controls: HCCS-AG-001 through HCCS-AG-010

4.4.1 Maturity Progression

Level	AG: Progression
L1	AI tools in use with no inventory. Vendor defaults accepted.
L2	ADT inventory maintained. HITL partially implemented. Initial bias testing.
L3	Complete inventory. HITL with override authority for all decisions. Explainability documented. Bias testing regular. Candidate disclosure. ADT owners designated.
L4	A/B testing compares ADT vs. human accuracy. Adversarial testing for failure modes.
L5	Industry benchmarking contribution. Continuous drift detection.

4.4.2 Implementation Requirements

AI amplifies signal and error. No ADT may serve as sole decision-maker. All outputs must be explainable and reconstructable.

4.4.3 Operational Design

ADT Inventory Template

- Tool name, vendor, version
- Function: screen, score, rank, recommend, benchmark
- Decision scope and data inputs
- Output description
- Deployment and last review dates
- Accountable owner
- Human review point
- Bias testing schedule and results

HITL Requirements (AG-002)

- Reviewer has context about role and candidates
- Authority to override ADT
- Accountable for final decision
- Documents review including overrides

Passive batch approval does not satisfy this requirement.

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Disparate Impact Testing (AG-004)

- Selection rates by protected class (four-fifths rule)
- Score distribution by demographic group
- False rejection rates by group

If impact detected: document, evaluate modification, determine business necessity justification.

4.4.4 Evidence Requirements

- ADT inventory (AG-001)
- HITL review documentation (AG-002)
- Explainability docs (AG-003)
- Bias testing results (AG-004)
- Candidate disclosure records (AG-005)
- ADT audit trail (AG-006)
- Owner designations (AG-007)

4.4.5 Audit Test Procedures

Control ID	**AG-001**
Procedure	Request ADT inventory. Cross-reference with HR tech stack.
Evidence	Inventory with required fields. Tech stack documentation.
Conclusion	Complete and current = satisfied. Tools not inventoried = Critical.

Control ID	**AG-002**
Procedure	For sample ADT decisions, verify human reviewed output before it took effect.
Evidence	Review records. Authority matrix. Override documentation.
Conclusion	Human review with authority = satisfied. Auto-executed = Critical.

Control ID	**AG-004**
Procedure	Request bias testing results per ADT. Verify pre-deployment and scheduled intervals.
Evidence	Testing methodology, results, remediation.
Conclusion	Current and complete = satisfied. No testing = Critical.

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4.4.6 Worked Examples

Screening Tool

ATS scores and ranks candidates. Inventory entry documents algorithm, inputs, outputs. Recruiter reviews above-threshold AND 10% random below-threshold to catch false rejections. Overrides documented. Quarterly bias testing.

Compensation Tool

Analytics tool recommends salary ranges. Inventory documents data sources and methodology. Analyst reviews every recommendation against compensable factor analysis. Adjustments documented. Annual demographic testing.

4.4.7 Control Failures

- **Critical:** Automated rejection without human review.
- **Critical:** ADT in use but not inventoried.
- **Significant:** Human review is pro forma batch approval.
- **Significant:** Vendor black-box: organization cannot explain outputs.

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4.5 PI: Process Integrity

Controls: HCCS-PI-001 through HCCS-PI-008

4.5.1 Maturity Progression

Level	PI: Progression
L1	Inconsistent processes. No open/internal classification. Performative postings common.
L2	Classification introduced. Internal-preference documented. Consistent evaluation by source.
L3	All processes classified before posting. Ratios tracked. Timelines communicated. Feedback provided.
L4	Process audits across demographics. Candidate experience analyzed.
L5	Anonymized metrics published. Continuous improvement.

4.5.2 Implementation

Operationalizes procedural justice: consistency, bias suppression, accuracy, correctability, representativeness, ethicality.

Process Classification

- **Open:** No preferred candidate. Genuine equal evaluation.
- **Internal-Preference:** Internal candidate identified. Documented. External candidates still evaluated on same criteria.
- **Restricted:** Internal only. Not posted externally.

The failure is not having an internal candidate. The failure is not disclosing it.

4.5.3 Operational Design

Candidate Communication (PI-005)

- Acknowledgment within 5 business days
- Status update at each stage transition
- Timeline estimate with proactive deviation notification
- Decision within 5 business days of final decision

Substantive Feedback (PI-006)

- References evaluation criteria
- Identifies specific unmet threshold

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- Delivered by person, not automated system

4.5.4 Evidence Requirements

- Process classification records (PI-001, PI-002)
- Evaluation consistency records (PI-003)
- Internal-preference ratios (L3+, PI-004)
- Communication records (L3+, PI-005)
- Feedback documentation (L3+, PI-006)

4.5.5 Audit Test Procedures

Control ID	**PI-001/002**
Procedure	Verify roles classified before posting. For open roles, verify genuine external evaluation.
Evidence	Classification records with timestamps. Hire outcomes.
Conclusion	Classification exists and open = genuine = satisfied. Open but predetermined = Critical.

Control ID	**PI-003**
Procedure	Compare evaluation for referred vs. non-referred candidates. Verify identical criteria and rigor.
Evidence	Evaluation records for both groups same role.
Conclusion	Consistent = satisfied. Abbreviated for referrals = Critical.

4.5.6 Worked Examples

Open: Five external, two internal evaluated on identical criteria. External selected. Consistent documentation throughout.

Internal-Preference: Documented before posting. Three external evaluated on same criteria. Internal scored highest. Classification prevents performative concern.

4.5.7 Control Failures

- **Critical:** Undisclosed performative posting with preselected candidate.
- **Critical:** Referred candidates given abbreviated evaluation.
- **Significant:** No process classification before posting.

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4.6 CG: Compensation Governance

Controls: HCCS-CG-001 through HCCS-CG-008

4.6.1 Maturity Progression

Level	CG: Progression
L1	Title-based pay. No factor analysis. Salary history may influence.
L2	Factors defined. Rationale documented for new hires.
L3	All compensation factor-based. Five factors analyzed. Annual alignment. Pay equity analysis.
L4	Real-time modeling when scope changes. Metrics tracked.
L5	Factor-based benchmarking contributed. Title-based pay eliminated.

4.6.2 Implementation

Compensable factors correct the disconnect between title-based shortcuts and actual scope. Five required factors:

- **Decision Authority:** What decisions, financial/strategic impact, approval levels.
- **Scope Complexity:** Systems, teams, geographies, ambiguity, competing priorities.
- **Accountability:** End-to-end ownership, consequences of failure, shared vs. individual.
- **Business Impact:** Revenue, cost, risk, strategic impact. Impact radius.
- **Required Expertise:** Non-trainable knowledge/skill. Market scarcity.

4.6.3 Operational Design

Compensation Rationale Documentation

- Factor scores for role
- Target range from factor analysis
- Actual offer/change amount
- Deviation rationale if outside range
- Confirmation salary history not used as determinant

4.6.4 Evidence Requirements

- Factor analysis per role (CG-001, CG-002)
- Compensation rationale (CG-003)
- Annual alignment review (L3+, CG-004)
- Pay equity analysis (L3+, CG-006)

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4.6.5 Audit Test Procedures

Control ID	**CG-001/002**
Procedure	Inspect factor analysis. Verify five factors scored. Verify compensation derived from factors, not title alone.
Evidence	Factor analysis documents. Offer records.
Conclusion	Factors informed compensation = satisfied. Title-only = Critical.

Control ID	**CG-006**
Procedure	Request pay equity analysis. Verify controls for compensable factors and demographic breakdowns.
Evidence	Analysis report with methodology.
Conclusion	Analysis with factor controls = satisfied. No analysis = Significant.

4.6.6 Worked Examples

Executive

VP Engineering: Authority 5/5, Complexity 5/5, Accountability 5/5, Impact 5/5, Expertise 4/5. Range: $280-340K. Offer: $310K. Rationale: payments migration expertise supports above-median.

Hourly

Associate: Authority 1/5, Complexity 2/5, Accountability 2/5, Impact 2/5, Expertise 1/5. Range: $18-22/hr. Offer: $20/hr. Rationale: mid-range, evening shift premium.

4.6.7 Control Failures

- **Critical:** Title-based pay with no factor analysis.
- **Critical:** Salary history as primary determinant.
- **Significant:** Factor analysis exists but compensation deviates without rationale.

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4.7 ER: Evidence and Records Governance

Controls: HCCS-ER-001 through HCCS-ER-009

4.7.1 Maturity Progression

Level	ER: Progression
L1	Records scattered, incomplete, not created at point of decision.
L2	Records created for most decisions. Retention policy. Classification in progress.
L3	Contemporaneous records for all decisions. 3-year retention. Classified, retrievable. Access restricted and logged.
L4	Automated evidence collection. Completeness audits.
L5	Tamper-evident storage. Continuous improvement from audit findings.

4.7.2 Implementation

Evidence standard: records sufficient for independent reviewer to reach same conclusion from documented record alone. Retrospective reconstruction does not satisfy.

Contemporaneous Windows

- Scorecards: within 4 hours of evaluation
- Decision rationale: within 24 hours of decision
- Process classification: before posting
- ADT review: before decision takes effect

Records >72 hours after event are retrospective and do not satisfy contemporaneous requirements.

4.7.3 Operational Design

- Creation at point of decision
- Classification by: domain, decision type, date
- Linkage to control IDs
- Retrieval within 48 hours of request
- Role-based access with logging
- 3-year minimum retention

4.7.4 Evidence Requirements

- Contemporaneous records with timestamps (ER-001)
- Retention policy and evidence (ER-002)

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- Classification schema and retrieval demo (ER-003)
- Accountability designations (ER-004)
- Control ID linkage (L3+, ER-005)
- Access logs (L3+, ER-006)

4.7.5 Audit Test Procedures

Control ID	**ER-001**
Procedure	Inspect record timestamps. Verify within contemporaneous windows.
Evidence	Record timestamps vs. event timestamps.
Conclusion	Within windows = satisfied. >72 hours = Critical.

Control ID	**ER-003**
Procedure	Request random decision record. Measure retrieval time. Verify classification.
Evidence	Retrieved records with metadata. Time measurement.
Conclusion	Retrieved <48 hrs with classification = satisfied. Cannot locate = Significant.

4.7.6 Worked Examples

Compliant: HRIS custom module auto-creates records with decision ID, domain tag, timestamp. Scorecards auto-save on submit. Rationale forms lock after 24 hours. Role-based access. All access logged. 5-year retention. Quarterly completeness audits.

4.7.7 Control Failures

- **Critical:** Missing records for a decision during audit period.
- **Critical:** Post-hoc documentation created weeks after decisions.
- **Significant:** Records scattered across email, spreadsheets, Slack with no centralized retrieval.

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5. Assessor and Auditor Qualification

Core Standard Section 6.1 requires competent assessors. This section defines criteria.

5.1 Qualified Assessor (Level 3)

Must meet at least 3 of 5:

- 5+ years HR management, operations, or talent acquisition at senior level
- 3+ years internal audit, compliance, or risk management
- Employment law and anti-discrimination expertise
- Personnel selection research and structured evaluation knowledge
- Relevant certification (SHRM-SCP, SPHR, CIA, CISA, AIGP, SIOP)

5.2 Qualified Auditor (Level 4-5)

Must meet at least 4 of 6:

- All assessor criteria
- 3+ years controls-based audit experience
- Audit methodology competence (sampling, evidence, findings)
- AI governance and ADT evaluation knowledge
- Forensic/organizational psychology expertise in selection
- Independence: no relationship with audited org within 24 months

5.3 Independence

Level 3: internal assessors permitted if independent of HR. Internal audit, legal, compliance acceptable.

Level 4-5: external and independent required. 24-month cooling period applies to individual, not firm.

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6. Role-Based Responsibilities

Domain	Hiring Mgr	Evaluators	HR/People	Int. Audit
RG	Accountable	Consulted	Supports	Validates
EI	Consulted	Accountable	Designs	Validates
DG	Accountable	Responsible	Supports	Validates
AG	Informed	Informed	Accountable	Validates
PI	Responsible	Informed	Accountable	Validates
CG	Consulted	Informed	Accountable	Validates
ER	Responsible	Responsible	Accountable	Validates

6.1 AI Governance Lead

Designated owner accountable for ADT inventory, bias testing, HITL substantive review, and AG domain coordination with Internal Audit.

6.2 Executive Sponsor

VP/SVP level with authority across HR, Legal, and business. Accountable for commitment, resources, and escalation.

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7. Level 3 Implementation Playbook

Level 3 is the minimum for external credibility. Phased roadmap:

7.1 Phase 1: Foundation (Months 1-3)

- Designate executive sponsor and team
- Gap assessment against 25 MUST controls
- Deploy role definition template
- Create ADT inventory
- Establish records governance
- Implement decision rationale forms

7.2 Phase 2: Operationalization (Months 3-6)

- Deploy evaluation framework and scoring rubrics
- Train evaluators on structured evaluation and bias
- Implement structured debrief protocol
- Deploy process classification
- Compensable factor analysis for all roles
- Implement contemporaneous documentation

7.3 Phase 3: Compliance (Months 6-9)

- Activate all SHOULD controls or document departures
- Begin evaluator calibration (.70+)
- Construct validity review
- Cognitive load management
- Candidate communication protocols
- Initial pay equity analysis

7.4 Phase 4: Validation (Months 9-12)

- Internal control testing across 7 domains
- Remediate findings
- Engage qualified assessor
- Establish ongoing monitoring

Mature orgs can compress. L1 starting point: plan 12-18 months.

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Appendix A: Control-Evidence-Audit Mapping Matrix

Control	Primary Evidence	Audit Test
HCCS-RG-001	Role definition with pre-sourcing timestamp	Inspect definition date vs. first candidate
HCCS-RG-002	Outcome-based role content	Verify outcomes vs. task lists
HCCS-EI-001	Criteria linked to role definition	Verify derivation and date
HCCS-EI-002	Identical scorecards across candidates	Compare criteria across set
HCCS-EI-006	Calibration with reliability data	Verify .70+ and remediation
HCCS-DG-001	Decision rationale with timestamp	Verify contemporaneous, criteria-referenced
HCCS-DG-002	Criteria-referenced rationale	Check rationalization indicators
HCCS-AG-001	Complete ADT inventory	Cross-ref tech stack
HCCS-AG-002	HITL review with authority	Verify review before effect
HCCS-AG-004	Disparate impact results	Verify schedule and remediation
HCCS-PI-001	Process classification records	Verify classification before posting
HCCS-CG-001	Compensable factor analysis	Verify factor-based determination
HCCS-ER-001	Record timestamps in windows	Compare creation to event
HCCS-ER-003	Classification and retrieval	Request random record, measure time

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Appendix B: Control Failure Severity Definitions

The following severity classifications are used throughout this guide and in HCCS audit reports.

Severity	Definition
Critical	A MUST control is absent or non-functional, or the control failure invalidates decision integrity. The organization cannot claim compliance at any maturity level for the affected domain. Immediate remediation required.
Significant	A SHOULD control is absent at Level 3+ without documented rationale, or a MUST control is operational but inconsistently applied. The control weakness increases risk but does not invalidate the entire decision process. Remediation plan required within 90 days.
Minor	A MAY practice is absent at Level 4+, or documentation is incomplete but the underlying control is operational. The finding represents an improvement opportunity. Should be addressed within the next compliance period.

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